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Did you know...

According to a recent US study there are more female tech entrepreneurs in the Middle East than anywhere else in the world. How come? Read on... <http://dgit.in/1g1Ym6A>

2. **Fish for hidden file content:** The data stored on the disk makes up the largest part of the investigation. A number of times you may have to look at a stockpile of files that may appear useless to their original user, but will eventually prove quite useful. Auto-save information saved by Microsoft Word or backup files generated when editing files by Linux OS are some of the mildest examples. The good as well as bad thing about these files is that they're not visible to a user and normally just left on the disk by the OS or the program that creates them. In case they're deleted, the normal deletion method is used. This would be the same as deleting a file from Trash or Recycle Bin, which means they can be eventually recovered.
3. **Rely on tools to assist you:** At this point, you're probably wondering how you'll be able to read a Word document's auto-save backup file. If you try to read the file in its raw form, your brain is bound to cheat you. That's because it isn't a plain text file. Registry is one of the creators of such a file. Interpreting the file will be impossible if you rely on your brains alone. You'll need tools that can interpret the data you found on the disk. A simple example, here – MS Word can open a Word file recovered from a disk.

Tools, formats and rights

For dealing with data, you'll need appropriate tools at each step. For example, if you want to extract the disk image from an evidence disk, there are many tools that can help you get the image. To create an image as well there are multiple tools available, from free and well known tools such as the 'dd' command on Linux to a complete set of forensic tools such as EnCase. Oftentimes, a single tool can't be relied upon and one might need to, say, create an image using different tools.

File formats are crucial largely because they're involved at almost every level of the investigation process. From extracting images to reading the data, one needs to deal with an extremely vast set of formats. Hypothetically, if you took the disk image using EnCase, then you would need

EnCase to read the format in which the image file was stored. Assuming that your evidence disk was taken from an iMac machine, you'd need a way to read the HFS+ file system used by Mac OS X. Once the data is extracted, you'd again need software to read the data. If it's a .dwg file, only AutoCAD would be able to open that file. You'd have to deal with a plethora of formats all the way.

Lastly, you can't simply start off with a forensic investigation and not have the required rights. you need to be a part of the police force or an investigative agency authorised to handle the case. And of course, you must have the right to use the software/tools involved.



Keep an eye on your security

Careers in Cyber Forensics

It's by the virtue of the career opportunities that the attractiveness of a discipline is determined. Though not a popular field, Digital Forensics has opportunities in both the private and public sector. Interestingly, there are positions in both sectors where one needs to use this knowledge to destroy data, as well as recover it.

- **Revenue Department:** Organisations dealing with money directly, both private and public need to trace financial crimes. This involves digging the data graves on the disk and creating the timeline of who did what and in what order – challenging, interesting and intellectually rewarding.
- **Malware Analysis:** Companies trying to create anti-viruses often need to

inspect the patterns of data destruction as well trace malwares that may have deleted themselves after their mission was complete. Forensics experts are certainly a necessity here.

- **Government and Police:** Crime investigations conducted by intelligence agencies, police and cyber security cells often require a forensics expert to help them walk a tightrope without falling off. With time, as electronic media takes over our lives, forensics is supposed to take over a large share of crime and thus, investigative processes.
- **Private Auditing Companies:** There are companies that dedicate themselves to the job of Forensics Consultation

needed by other entities. You guessed it right. These are private detectives.

- **Trainer:** There certainly is a lack of talent in this field. Trainers are required at all of the prior mentioned organisations. And as it happens in many cases, being a trainer on rare and intellectually challenging cases is quite rewarding.

That being said, Cyber Forensics is an ever-changing landscape. New types of storage media and software are introduced all the time, ensuring new challenges to overcome keeping those in the field on their toes. You can rest assured that the environment will keep you updated on the latest in technology and in touch with a very wide array of technology. 